CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PRINT-ON-DEMAND SELLER IN THE AI ERA

Your designs on their shelves — no printer, no stock, no garage full of unsold shirts.

★ **TL;DR — Around $45K a year for a seller with a working catalog, startable in 1–6 months. The catch: per-item margins are thin by design — volume and winners carry you, not any single shirt.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

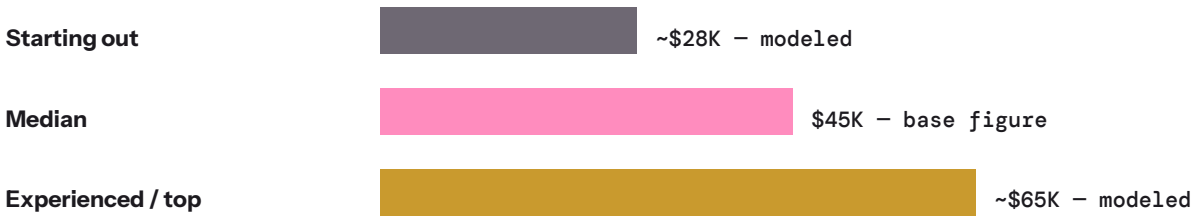
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- The platform prints, ships and handles returns; you supply the design and the listing.
- Thin margins mean the game is a portfolio: many decent designs, a few real winners.
- AI design tools flooded the zone — generic slogans are dead; specific niches with inside jokes still sell.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Print-on-Demand Seller is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PRINT-ON-DEMAND SELLER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Research niches and occasions buyers shop for: professions, hobbies, family roles, humor
- ✓ Create designs and mockups, upload and price products

✓ Write listings that target the exact search the buyer types

✓ Watch sales data, retire losers and expand winners into more products

Think: a songwriter who gets small royalties per play — you need a catalog, not one good chorus.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI generates shirt graphics, mockups and listing copy in minutes, which crushed the value of anything generic. Trademark and trend scanning are automated too.	The niche instinct stays human: knowing what makes a fishing dad, a nurse or a first-time grandma laugh at checkout — and respecting trademarks so your shop survives.

⚠ **One trademarked phrase can end the whole shop — movie quotes, team names and brand logos are landmines. And with thin margins, a design that 'sells okay' may still lose to fees and ad costs.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Zero inventory and zero shipping trips ✓ Design from anywhere, sell worldwide ✓ A winner design pays you for months untouched	✗ Most designs will sell almost nothing — that is normal here ✗ Income is spiky around holidays and trends ✗ Platforms can suspend first and explain later

Good fit? A fast, funny designer with thick skin for data: you can publish fifty designs, read the two that work and build around them.

Bad fit? You fall in love with every design and cannot kill losers — or you plan to copy what's already selling, word for word.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — NICHE HUMOR AND IDENTITY	DOOR B — OCCASION AND TREND SURFING
The steady route: pick communities with proud identities — occupations, hobbies, family roles — and design for their inside language. Specific beats clever: buyers search for exactly who they are.	Ride the calendar: holidays, awareness months, elections, viral moments. Faster money, constant churn — you are designing next month's spike while this month's fades.

Smart move: Expand sideways from every winner: one design that sells becomes ten products and five gift variations before you chase a new idea. Winners are rare — milk them properly.

Where you land after: A catalog with evergreen winners — then your own store with better margins, or licensing designs to brands.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PICK THREE	SET UP	PUBLISH THE	READ THE	SCALE THE	PROTECT THE

STEP 1 — Pick three niche communities

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Choose groups you understand — their jokes, pride and gift occasions — and check what already sells to them.
- Learn the trademark rules cold before designing anything: no brands, teams, lyrics or characters. Ever.

STEP 2 — Set up the seller stack

$0-100 · 1 WEEK

- Open accounts with one print-on-demand platform and the marketplace you will sell through.
- Order a sample of your own product — if the print quality embarrasses you, change providers now.

STEP 3 — Publish the first twenty designs

$0-200 · 2-4 WEEKS

- Design in batches around your niches; simple, readable, made for the specific buyer.
- List with the buyer's search words and clean mockups — the thumbnail is the product.

STEP 4 — Read the data without mercy

FREE · WEEKLY

- Track views, favorites and sales per design. No sales with views means design problem; no views means listing problem.
- Retire or rework the bottom; do not let dead designs clog the shop.

STEP 5 — Scale the winners sideways

PAID · MONTH 2+

- Every selling design expands: more products, more colors, gift-angle variations.
- Build a small series per niche so buyers who found one design find five.

STEP 6 — Protect the shop

FREE · ONGOING

- Re-check your catalog for risky phrases before platforms do it for you.
- Diversify: second marketplace or your own storefront once one channel pays steadily.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: pick three niches and write the trademark rules on a sticky note above your desk.

- Days 1–30: open accounts, order a quality sample, publish your first twenty designs.
- Days 31–60: read the data weekly, kill losers, add twenty more aimed by what you learned.
- Days 61–90: expand every winner sideways and build series inside your best niche.
- Day 90: a working catalog with identified winners — growth is now a system, not a lottery ticket.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ ONE WINNER PAYS FOR FIFTY MAYBES. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.